Between Bodies

A space installation offering a space for contemplative healing, focusing on contemporary societal perspectives regarding organ transplantation and the phenomenon of donation.



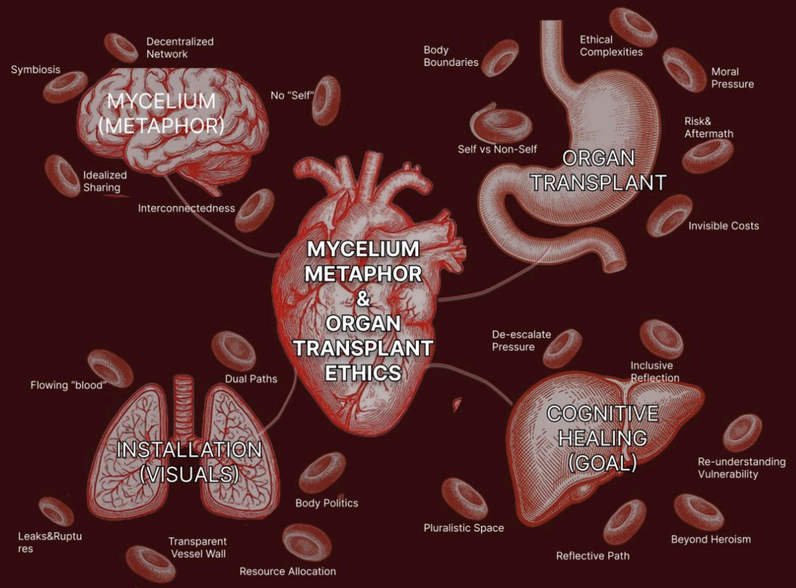
Inspiration

Mycelium -
nature's interconnected web

Mycelium has no single center, with blurred individual boundaries—all life interconnected through it. This embodies the ecological manifestation of "Anatta" (non-self): nothing exists independently; all phenomena arise interdependently.



Brainstorm



Research



Global Organ Transplants：~150K–170K

10%

Practical & Concise

$12,875 ▲10%

Global Organ Donors 2024

47180

Organ Transplant Demand: China

30w +76



A forced "must"

Essentially, it distorts organ donation from a "voluntary choice" into a "moral obligation." It uses an unquestionable tone to portray "altruism" as the only correct answer, while deliberately erasing the individual's sovereignty over their body—"I "must" donate."



Between "Great Love" and "Self"

The parents in this news story exemplified "symbiosis" in an extreme way: giving their child's body to others so that life could continue in another form. But this choice was never purely selfless; it was mixed with longing for their child, reluctance to part with life, and a struggle to find meaning in immense grief.



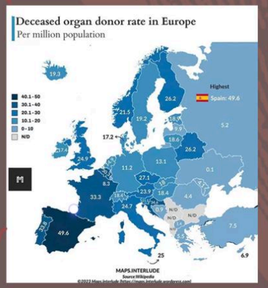
Refusing is not "selfish".

Refusing to donate is not to deny the meaning of altruism, but rather because she cannot accept the idea of using the dismemberment of a child's body to accomplish a so-called "noble" act.



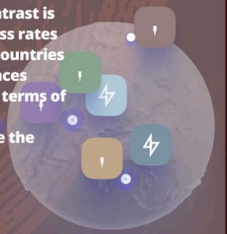
Books and Academic Reflections

Literature on medical ethics and body research has long pointed out that the body is not absolutely "private," nor should it be forcibly "publicized." The core contradiction in organ transplantation has never been "to donate or not to donate," but rather how to build a fairer medical allocation system while respecting individual autonomy.



The physical divide behind the numbers

When global organ donation and transplant success rates are presented, a stark contrast is often overlooked: the gap in organ access rates between high-income and low-income countries can be dozens of times, and the differences between the wealthy and vulnerable in terms of waiting list priority and post-operative rehabilitation resources directly rewrite the narrative of "equality of life".



Interview



Jiarong Occupation: Student

Acceptability 90%

·Previous donation activities:

blood donation

·Any adverse reactions after donation?

"I was a little dizzy at the time, but it subsided after a while, and I feel fine now."



Occupation: Consultant **Yuan**

Acceptability 95%

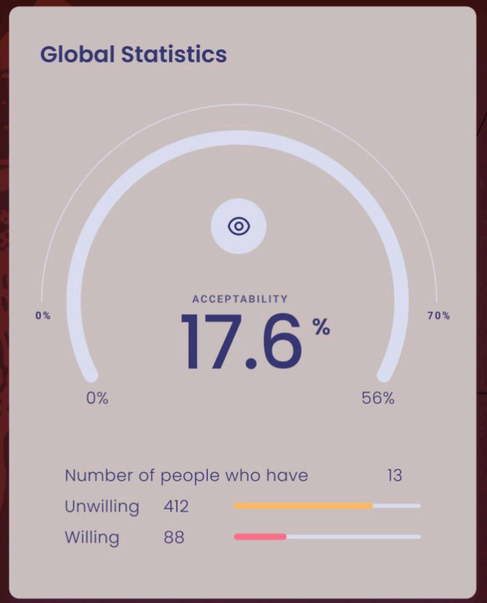
·Previous donation activities:

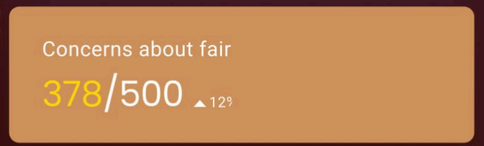
Family members have donated livers

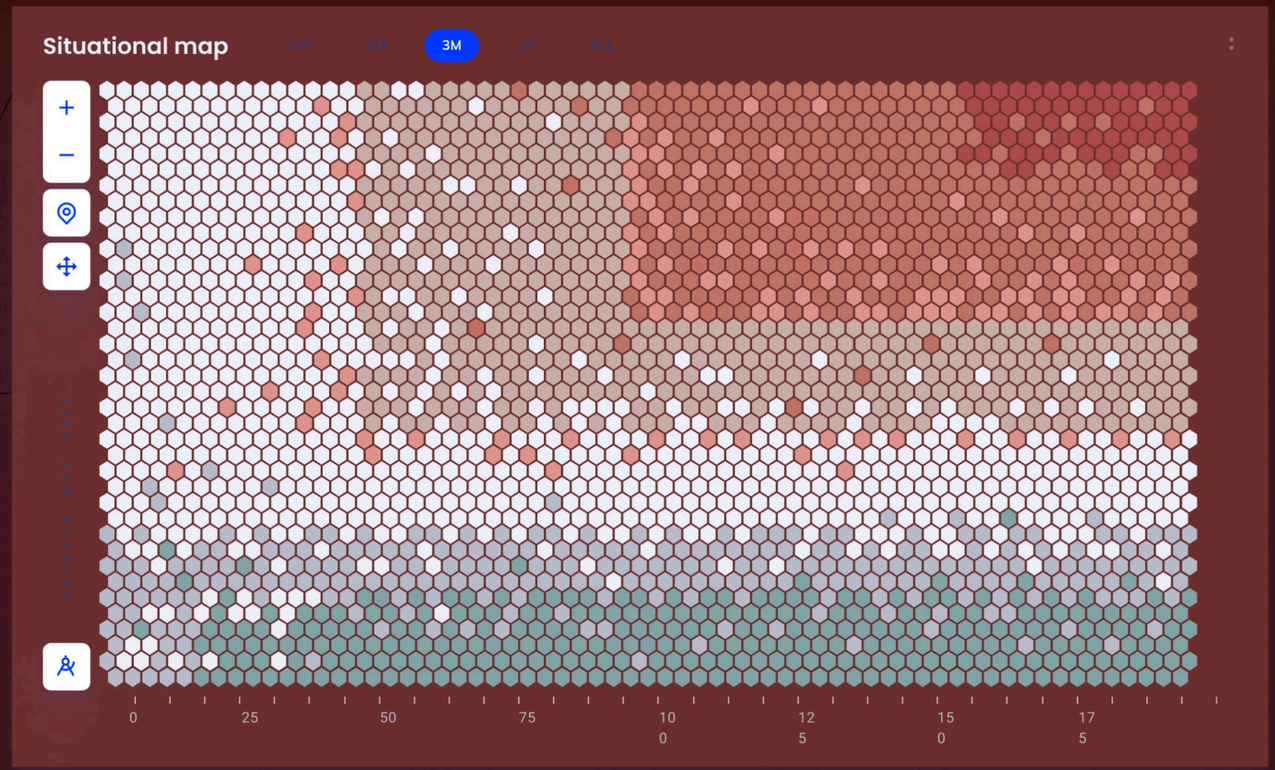
·Any adverse reactions after donation?

"My family member experienced some pain for a few days after the donation, but several months have passed and there haven't been any major side effects. However, I feel that his memory has become somewhat impaired."

Questionnaire







Summary

PARAMETER	TOTAL	TODAY	STATUS	PERCENT	DYNAMICS
Views	597 989	120 430		438	+10%
Sales	543 409	120		321	+10%
Users	467 320	3 210		210	+10%
Product	320 210	90		198	+10%

CONCLUSION

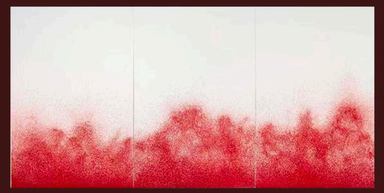
Survey data indicates that among 500 respondents, only 17.6% held a highly open and accepting attitude toward organ donation, while more than half expressed concerns regarding fairness. Furthermore, among those willing to donate, 32% were influenced by sentiments of heroism or moral pressure; their complete acceptance was not based on a full understanding of the organ donation process and its consequences.

Reference

Chiharu Shiota



A vast, intricate network of lines (primarily red, black, and white) is woven to convey a profound reflection on the fragility of life.



Thijs Biersteker



Through a complex piping system, the tiny elements in the polluted water are moved in a hypnotic manner.

Creative Inspiration

- Inspired by Chiharu Shiota's red threads and Thijs Biersteker's fluid systems
- Explores the tension between self and selflessness in organ transplantation
- Uses mycelium and flowing pipes as visual elements
- Visualizes vulnerability, symbiosis, and ethical complexity

Ideas

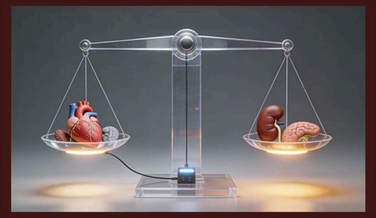
Meditation Space



There were fewer opportunities for participants to explore on their own.

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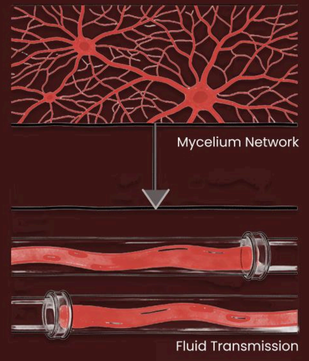
Organ transplant balance



Not all organ donations can be measured by body temperature; this method makes organ donation feel cold and impersonal.

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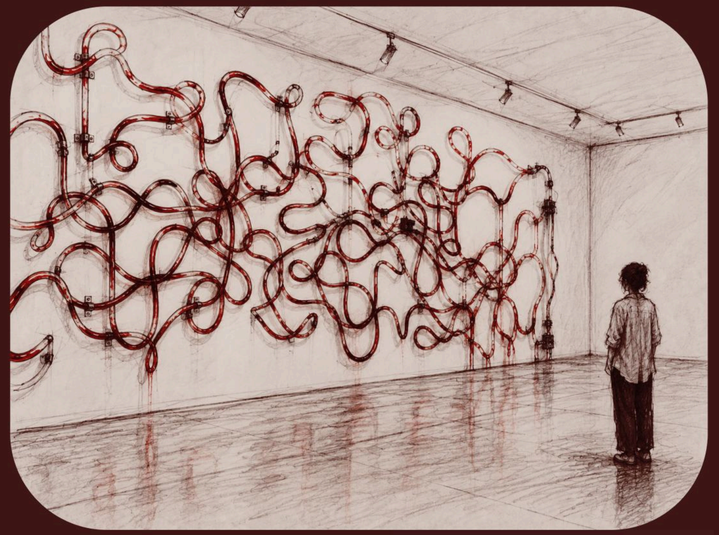
Blood circulation interactive device



The design of the blood vessel wall provides ample space for viewers to explore and reflect. It metaphorically represents various ideas, telling us that willingness or unwillingness to undergo organ transplantation is an option, while also informing viewers of the potential risks of transplantation.

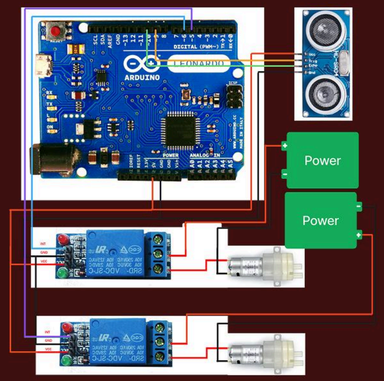
★★★

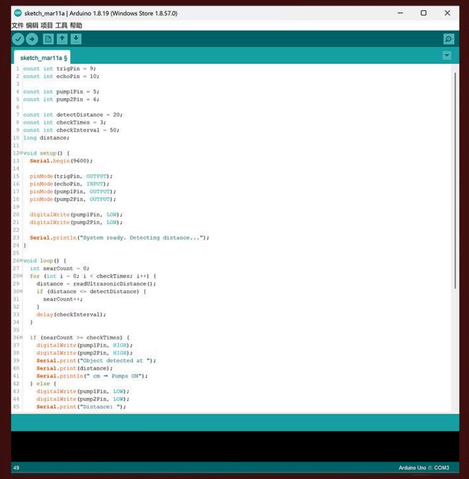
Sketch





Coding





```
const int trigPin = 9;
const int echoPin = 10;

const int pump1Pin = 5;
const int pump2Pin = 6;

const int detectDistance = 20;
const int checkTimes = 3;
const int checkInterval = 50;
long distance;

void setup() {
  Serial.begin(9600);

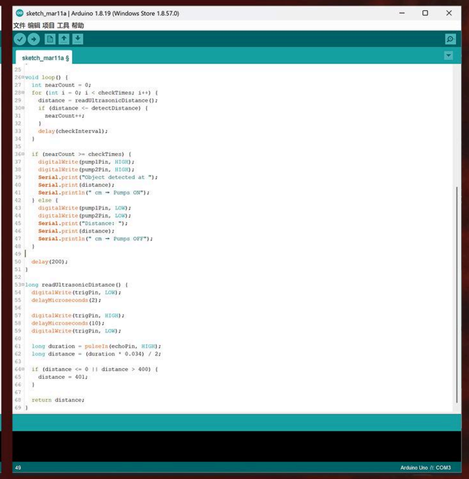
  pinMode(trigPin, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(echoPin, INPUT);
  pinMode(pump1Pin, OUTPUT);
  pinMode(pump2Pin, OUTPUT);

  digitalWrite(pump1Pin, LOW);
  digitalWrite(pump2Pin, LOW);

  Serial.println("System ready. Detecting distance...");
}

void loop() {
  int nearCount = 0;
  for (int i = 0; i < checkTimes; i++) {
    distance = readUltrasonicDistance();
    if (distance <= detectDistance) {
      nearCount++;
    }
    delay(checkInterval);
  }

  if (nearCount >= checkTimes) {
    digitalWrite(pump1Pin, HIGH);
    digitalWrite(pump2Pin, HIGH);
    Serial.print("Object detected at ");
    Serial.print(distance);
    Serial.println(" cm → Pumps ON");
  } else {
    digitalWrite(pump1Pin, LOW);
    digitalWrite(pump2Pin, LOW);
    Serial.print("Distance: ");
```



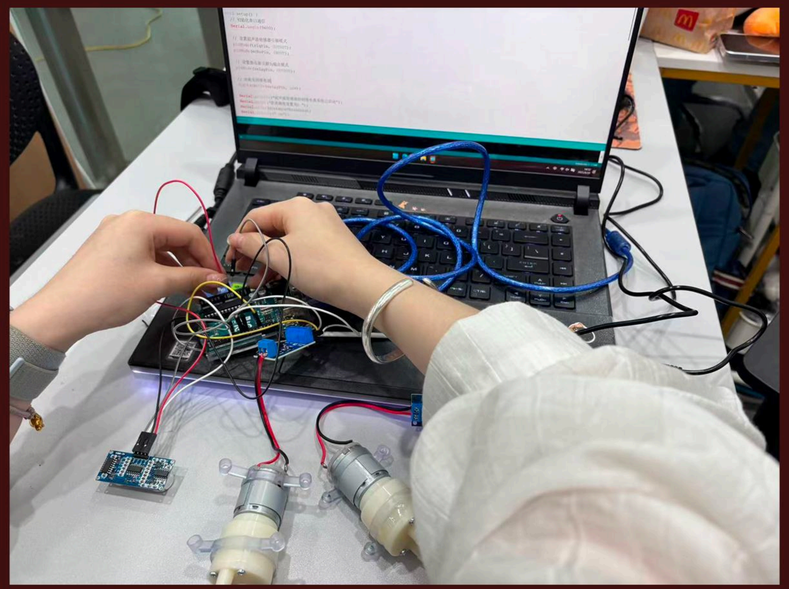
```
long readUltrasonicDistance() {
  digitalWrite(trigPin, LOW);
  delayMicroseconds(2);

  digitalWrite(trigPin, HIGH);
  delayMicroseconds(10);
  digitalWrite(trigPin, LOW);

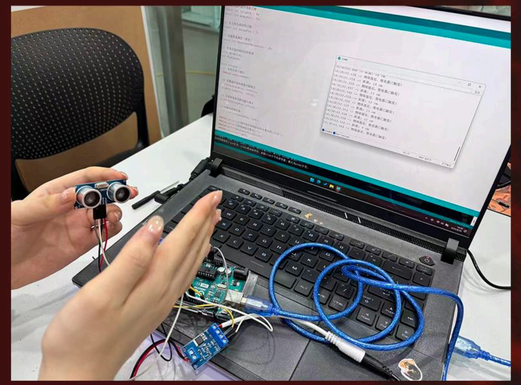
  long duration = pulseIn(echoPin, HIGH);
  long distance = (duration * 0.034) / 2;

  if (distance <= 0 || distance > 400) {
    distance = 401;
  }

  return distance;
}
```

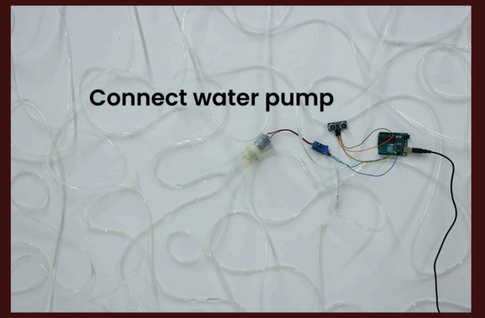


An interactive program is implemented using infrared and distance sensors to complete the operation of the water pump.

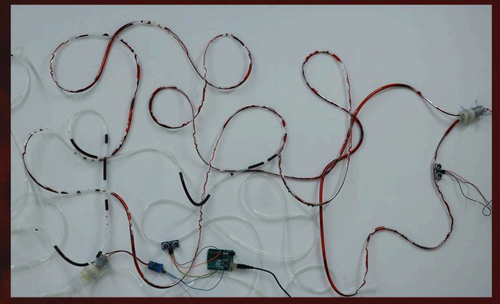


Making / Test



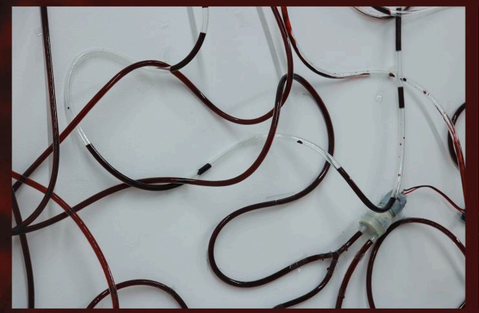


The water pipes were laid all over the wall according to the predetermined route.





One section of the water pipes is connected in a loop, so it can keep running as long as the sensor detects it.

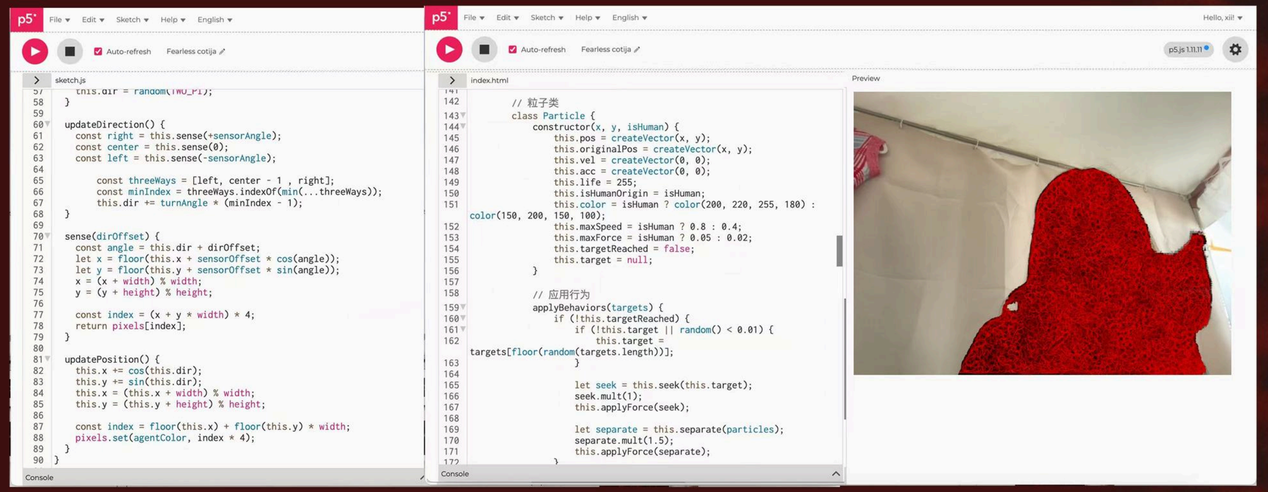


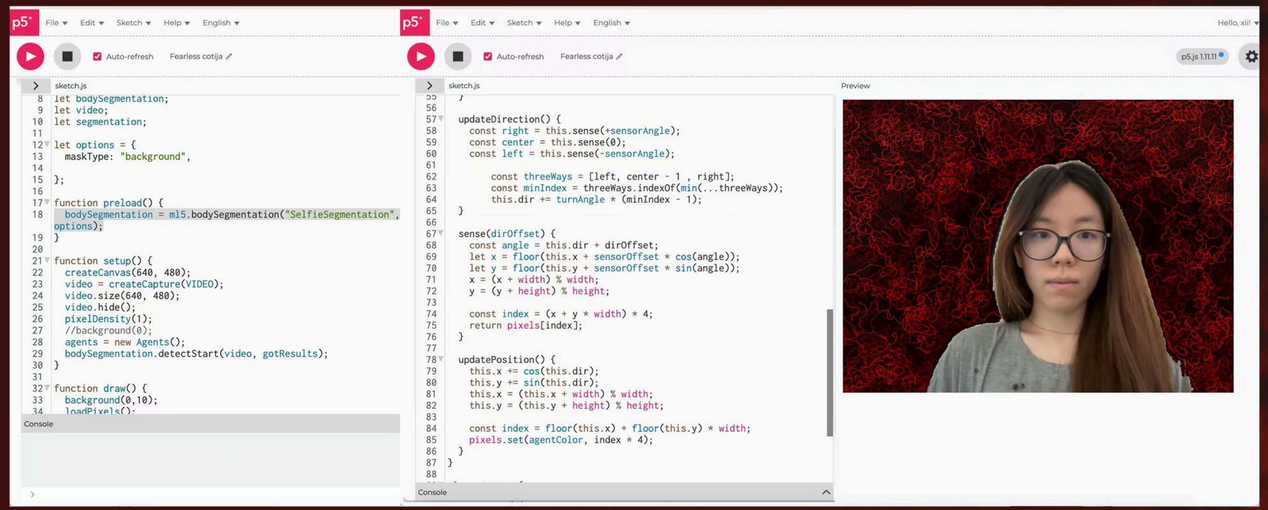


A leaky water pipe could cause blood to leak during operation, reflecting a potential risk associated with organ transplant surgery.

Coding

Within the p5.js framework, body contour recognition using ml5 is employed to assist in generating mycelial-like red fine line growth patterns.

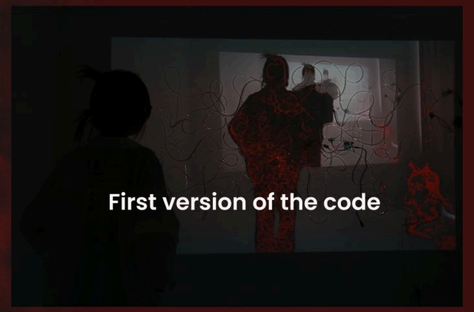




Making/test



On my first try, I found the projector's performance to be poor, so I replaced it.





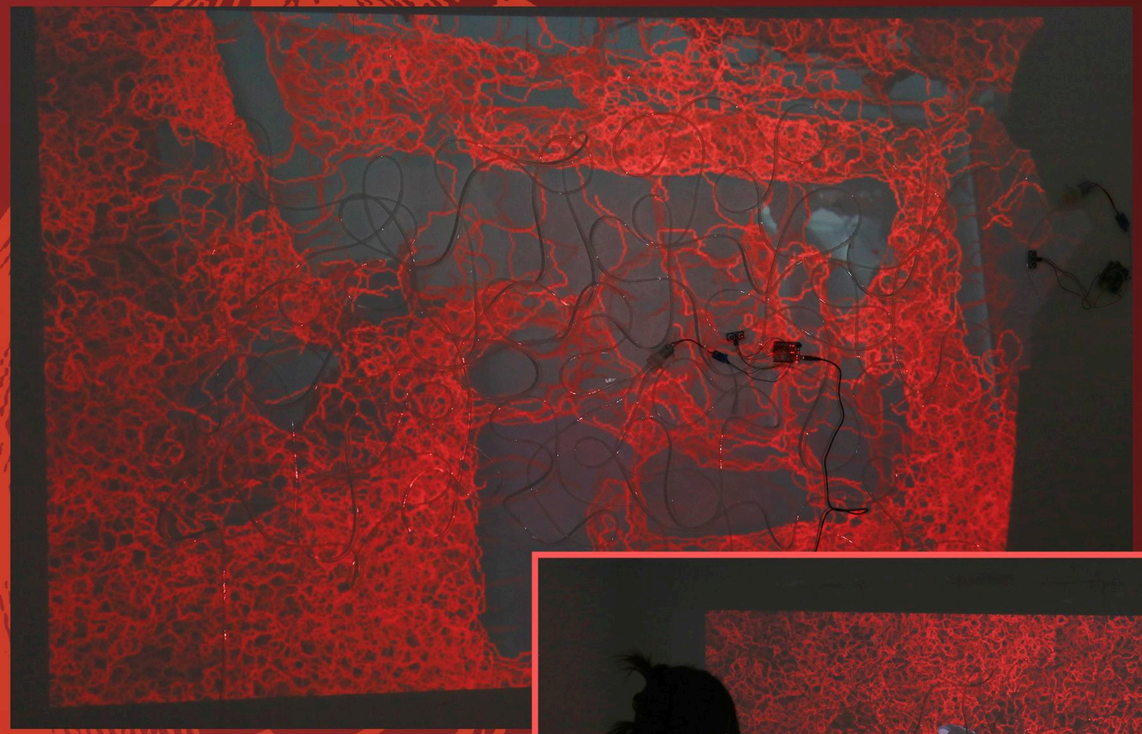
You can see the red lines growing inside the body, but they lack tension.

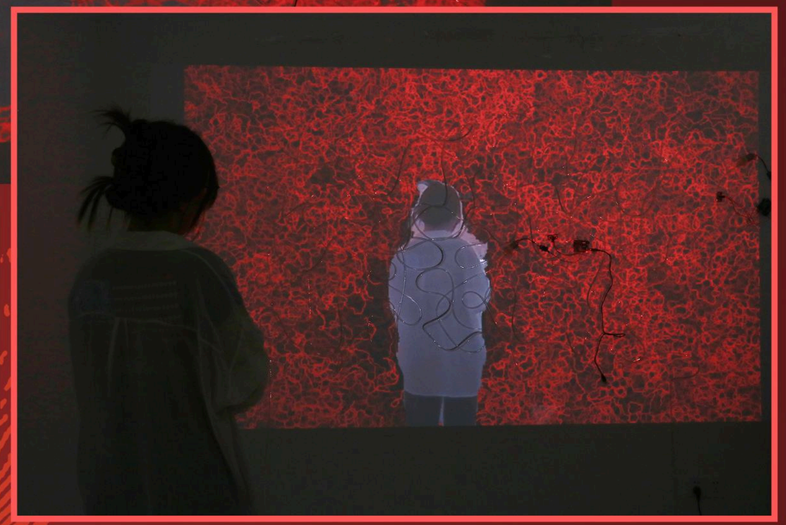




A red line fills the entire screen, growing rapidly in the shadows as the body moves across it; the form of expression fits the theme and is sufficiently expressive.

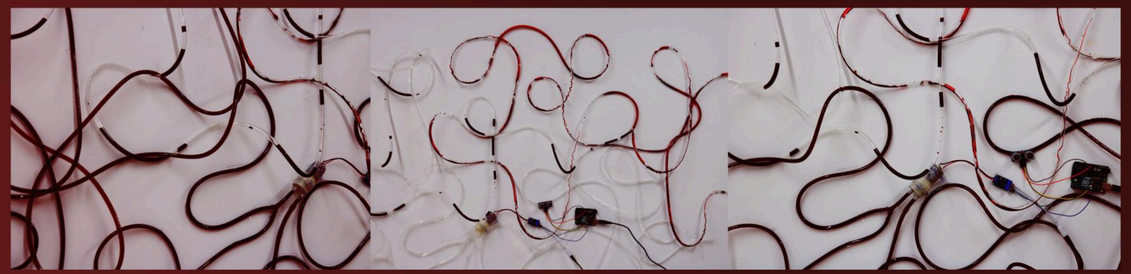
Final











Video Link: